

Days of the Apocalypse

Development Roadmap

PlayStation 5 Release - Q3 2027

Project Overview

Project Status: In Development

Target Release: Q3 2027 - PlayStation 5

PS4 Version: Q4 2027

Core Deliverables

- 30+ hours single-player story
- 60+ km² open-world environment
- 5 major story endings
- 1,000+ dialogue trees
- Hybrid real-time combat with tactical pause
- Full survival mechanics suite
- Cooperative multiplayer elements

Release Timeline

Q3 2026: Pre-Production (July - September)

Q4 2026: Production Phase 1 (October - December)

Q1 2027: Production Phase 2 (January - March)

Q2 2027: Production Phase 3 (April - June)

Q3 2027: Alpha/Beta & Launch (July - September)

Team Structure

Core Leadership: 5 positions

Gameplay Programmers: 8-10

Engine/Tools: 5-6

Art & Animation: 12-15

Audio & Sound: 3-4

Design: 4-6

QA & Testing: 8-12

Production Management: 2-3

Total: 45-55 team members at peak

Q3 2026: Pre-Production Phase

Sprint 1: Design & Pipeline Setup

Duration: July - August 2026

Objectives: Finalize design, establish asset pipeline

Key Deliverables:

- Complete Game Design Document
- Technical Design Document
- Art style guide & asset specifications
- Combat system specifications
- Dialogue & narrative framework
- Engine setup with Unreal Engine 5
- CI/CD pipeline & source control
- Basic character controller prototype
- Combat interaction prototype

Milestones:

Week 2: Design document approval

Week 4: Pipeline architecture complete

Week 6: Development environment ready

Week 8: First playable prototype

Sprint 2: Vertical Slice & Proof of Concept

Duration: August - September 2026

Objectives: Build vertical slice, validate mechanics

Key Deliverables:

- 15-20 minute playable vertical slice
- Combat system prototype (melee + ranged)
- Resource management system (basic)
- Environmental interaction system
- Character animation rig
- Audio placeholder system
- UI framework
- Performance profiling report

Success Criteria:

- Combat responsiveness < 50ms input lag
- 60 FPS maintained in slice area
- Core mechanics validated by stakeholders
- Team confident in technical approach

Q4 2026: Production Phase 1

Sprint 3: Combat System Implementation

Duration: October 2026

Key Deliverables:

- Full melee combat system
- Ranged combat system (guns, bows, throwables)
- Improvised weapons system
- Tactical pause mechanic
- Basic enemy AI (patrol, chase, attack)
- Boss fight framework
- 100+ combat animations
- Hit detection & damage calculation
- Weapon progression system

Success Criteria: 8+ weapon types, 5+ enemy types, polished feel

Sprint 4: Survival Mechanics & Inventory

Duration: November 2026

Key Deliverables:

- Health system (damage, healing, death)
- Hunger/thirst/fatigue systems
- Inventory management UI
- Equipment system (armor, accessories)
- Crafting system (150+ recipes)
- Resource gathering mechanics
- Environmental hazards system
- Safe zone mechanics
- Save system

Success Criteria: 50+ craftable items, intuitive UI, resource economy balanced

Sprint 5: World Foundation & Level Design

Duration: November - December 2026

Key Deliverables:

- World map layout (60+ km²)
- 5 major regions defined
- Underground bunker network
- 100+ landmark placement
- Environmental art style finalized
- 5+ biome types
- Day/night cycle system
- Dynamic weather system
- Traversal mechanics

Q1 2027: Production Phase 2

Sprint 7: Region 1 & 2 Development

Duration: January 2027

Region 1 - Urban Ruins:

- 30+ points of interest
- 20+ side quests
- 15+ story encounters

Region 2 - Industrial Zone:

- 25+ points of interest
- 18+ side quests
- 12+ story encounters

Additional: Environmental storytelling, dynamic events

Sprint 8: Region 3 & Underground Systems

Duration: February 2027

Region 3 - Forest Reclamation:

- 35+ points of interest
- 22+ side quests
- 20+ environmental puzzles

Underground Systems:

- 10+ major bunkers interconnected
- Locked doors & access systems
- Environmental hazards
- 50+ hidden areas & secrets

Sprint 9 & 10: Region 4, 5 & Story Integration

Duration: March 2027

Region 4 - Administrative Center:

- 30+ points of interest
- 15+ story quests (high priority)
- Faction headquarters

Region 5 - Forbidden Zone:

- 25+ points of interest
- Story-critical encounters
- Boss fight arena

Narrative: 5 major story endings fully implemented

Q2 2027: Production Phase 3

Sprint 11: Audio & Music Implementation

Key Deliverables:

- 2+ hours original soundtrack
- Environmental audio (wind, water, creatures)
- Combat audio (impacts, enemy sounds)
- Voice acting implementation (1,000+ lines)
- Audio mixing & master
- Dynamic music system
- 7.1 surround sound support

Sprint 12: Multiplayer Features

Key Deliverables:

- Co-op gameplay modes (2-4 players)
- Cooperative quests (15+)
- Matchmaking system
- Leaderboards
- Social features (guilds/clans)

Success Criteria: 30% multiplayer engagement target

Sprint 13: UI/UX Polish & Accessibility

Accessibility Options:

- Colorblind modes (3 types)
- Subtitle customization
- Controller remapping
- Difficulty modifiers
- Localization (8+ languages)